INSIDE STLC
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BETTER TESTERS BRIGHTER CAREERS

QA CV CHECKLIST THAT GETS INTERVIEWS

1-PAGE GUIDE

What actually got callbacks from a 100-application QA job experiment in 2026.

A stronger CV. A brighter tomorrow.



TOOLS IMPACT PEOPLE PROGRESS

1 WHAT ACTUALLY GOT CALLBACKS

Tools-led CV

4%
callback rate

Tools, but no context = low interest.

Impact-led CV

23%
callback rate

Impact and value **= 6x more callbacks.**

- Lead with business impact, not just tool names
- Use measurable outcomes: time saved, defects caught, regression reduced
- Show how your testing helped the team ship faster or safer

2 THE 7 LINES TO FIX THIS WEEK

- [ ] Replace the generic summary with a value headline
- [ ] Rewrite your top 3 bullets using impact + number
- [ ] Add one Playwright / automation project with a GitHub or CI link
- [ ] Show modern tools: Playwright, API, Git, CI/CD
- [ ] Move certifications below real project evidence
- [ ] Add one bullet showing bug, risk or release impact
- [ ] Keep your strongest proof in the top third of the CV

Small changes. Bigger opportunities.

3 WHAT GETS YOU IGNORED

- ✗ Generic profile summary
- ✗ No numbers or measurable outcomes
- ✗ Long tool lists with no context
- ✗ ISTQB at the top with no project evidence
- ✗ Responsibilities listed without business value

Don't just list tasks. Show value.

4 THE 30-SECOND HIRING MANAGER FILTER

- ✓ Risk thinking
- ✓ Product understanding
- ✓ Clear communication
- ✓ Modern delivery: Playwright, Git, CI/CD
- ✓ Business impact and decision-making

30s

If your CV cannot show value quickly, it usually gets skipped.

5 YOUR 7-DAY ACTION PLAN

Day 1-2:
Rewrite the top 3 bullets with impact + numbers

Day 3-4:
Add one automation project and CI run link

Day 5:
Get one trusted reviewer to check clarity

Day 6-7:
Apply to 10 targeted QA roles, not 100 random ones

Progress over perfection.

The testers getting interviews in 2026 are not just listing tools. They show risk thinking, business impact, communication and modern QA capability.